



Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack

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Radio Shack TRS-80® Model 4P Transportable Microcomputer

Enjoyed by McCall's Magazine's Reader of the Year

The woman selected as "Reader of the Year" by McCall's Magazine has plenty of reasons for using the Radio Shack TRS-80® Model 4P transportable microcomputer now residing elegantly on the desk in her bedroom.

Diana Hindt, a 33-year old mother of six and full-time oilfield equipment salesperson, said she'll use the computer to write letters, keep the family budget, track food prices, store inventory and accounting records from her husband's antique business and teach her youngest children computer programming.

"It's going to be a big help to have the computer here at home. I had a small computer a few years ago, but I had to bring it into the office. Now I'm going to bring the inventory and accounting records from my husband's antique business home," she said. She lives in a four-bedroom house in Katy, Texas, a suburb of Houston.

The daughter of a computer systems analyst, she says computers don't scare her. As a nine-year-old child visiting her father's office on Saturdays, she keypunched information into a mainframe computer.

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"I've been around computers all my life. I understand the concept of computers," she said.

The sleekly designed white Radio Shack computer and matching DWP-210 letter-quality daisy wheel printer, also from Radio Shack, were among the gifts she received when McCall's remodeled her home, in honor of her selection as Reader of the Year. Meant for business and home use, the 26-pound computer is supported by a wide selection of hardware and software.

Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack is the first computer company to participate in McCall's Reader of the Year contest. The winner, selected on the basis of a letter written to the magazine and interviews, receives a complete home and wardrobe makeover by magazine editors.

Along with the computer and printer, Hindt received the Scribesit® word processing program, PFS-File, a data filing program, and Thirteen Ghosts, a family game program. She plans to take computer classes at a Radio Shack Computer Center near her home.

"Having the computer at home is going to make things easier, such as writing letters to my family. I only have five brothers, two sets of grandparents, my mother and great grandparents. They all insist on getting letters from me," she said.

Using the computer, she said she'll be able to draft the body of a letter to use for several relatives, then personalize the beginning and end of each letter for each family member.

The monthly calendar Hindt keeps to track appointments will now be stored on the computer, along with comparisons of food prices at the local supermarkets, and household financial records.

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Her children are already interested in the computer. Genny, her 14-year-old daughter, has taken computer programming in school and enjoys writing simple programs that utilize the computer's sound capabilities. She and 4-year-old brother Garrett play with the computer together.

Mrs. Hindt said she's glad the children are interested in the computer.

"If these kids are not proficient with computers, they're going to be handicapped. This is a skill they need to know. I am raising my kids to be able to function well in their adult life. They do their own laundry, cook their own meals, clean their rooms, and do the bathrooms. It doesn't hurt them a lick," she said.

Her self-employed husband Bill, who imports antiques and antique reproductions, is still hesitant about using the computer.

"He's real nervous about it. He understands nothing about it, it's a foreign entity to him," she said. But the slender and articulate Mrs. Hindt seems unconcerned about her husband's lack of computer prowess.

"Bill's the nurturing homebody in the family. He cooks five nights a week!"

Radio Shack, the company that manufactures and markets the TRS-80 Model 4P Microcomputer, is a division of Tandy Corporation.

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